

Day 84 — TNPSC Group 2A Study Material

Part A – General Studies: Current Affairs in General Science (6): NIMHANS-2 and New Ayurveda Institutes (Budget 2026-27)

READING MATERIAL

Covers 2 Budget 2026-27 healthcare announcements: a second national mental-health institute (NIMHANS-2) and new Ayurveda/traditional-medicine infrastructure.

Q: What is NIMHANS-2, and when/where was it announced?

A: A second National Institute of Mental Health and Neuro Sciences, announced in the Union Budget 2026-27 (1 February 2026) by Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman — proposed to be set up in NORTH India (the original NIMHANS is in Bengaluru).

Q: Why was North India specifically chosen for NIMHANS-2?

A: Because there are currently NO national institutes for mental healthcare in North India — NIMHANS-2 aims to bridge this geographical gap in advanced mental-health infrastructure.

Q: What related mental-health infrastructure upgrade was also announced in Budget 2026-27?

A: Upgrading the premier mental-health institutions at Ranchi and Tezpur into Regional Apex Institutions, alongside proposed Emergency and Trauma Care Centres in every district hospital nationwide.

Q: What new Ayurveda/traditional-medicine infrastructure did Budget 2026-27 propose?

A: 3 new All India Institutes of Ayurveda, upgrades to AYUSH pharmacies and Drug Testing Labs, and an upgrade to the WHO Global Traditional Medicine Centre at Jamnagar (Gujarat).

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. NIMHANS-2, announced in Budget 2026-27, is proposed to be set up in:

- A. South India
- B. North India ✓**
- C. East India
- D. Bengaluru itself

Explanation: North India. [medium, web-research]

2. The original NIMHANS (after which NIMHANS-2 is modelled) is located in:

- A. Chennai
- B. Bengaluru ✓**
- C. Hyderabad
- D. Delhi

Explanation: Bengaluru. [easy, web-research]

3. Which 2 mental-health institutions were proposed for upgrade to Regional Apex Institutions in Budget 2026-27?

- A. Ranchi and Tezpur ✓**
- B. Pune and Nagpur
- C. Lucknow and Patna
- D. Bhopal and Jaipur

Explanation: Ranchi and Tezpur. [hard, web-research]

4. Budget 2026-27 proposed setting up how many new All India Institutes of Ayurveda?

- A. 1
- B. 2
- C. 3 ✓**
- D. 5

Explanation: 3. [medium, web-research]

5. The WHO Global Traditional Medicine Centre, slated for an upgrade in Budget 2026-27, is located at:

A. Jamnagar ✓

B. Rishikesh

C. Varanasi

D. Pune

Explanation: Jamnagar, Gujarat. [hard, web-research]

Part B – Aptitude & Mental Ability: Lowest Common Multiple (LCM)

READING MATERIAL

LCM is 1 of 10 named Aptitude sub-skills. Real exam evidence shows two distinct shapes: algebraic LCM-from-a-clue problems, and 'remainder' word problems — both are taught below as separate methods.

Q: Real exam (2025): If the LCM of 'a' and 'a+2' is 1300, find the LCM of 'a' and 'a+1'.

A: Since a and a+2 differ by 2, their HCF is either 1 or 2. If $\text{HCF}=2$: $\text{LCM} = a(a+2)/2 = 1300 \rightarrow a(a+2) = 2600$. Solving $a^2+2a-2600=0$ gives $a=50$ (check: $50 \times 52/2 = 1300$ ✓). Now find $\text{LCM}(50, 51)$: consecutive integers are always coprime ($\text{HCF}=1$), so $\text{LCM} = 50 \times 51 = 2550$.

Q: Method — 'least number leaving given remainders' (remainders differ from the divisors by a constant): Find the least number which, when divided by 16, 18, and 21, leaves remainders 3, 5, and 8 respectively.

A: Check the gap between each divisor and its remainder: $16-3=13$, $18-5=13$, $21-8=13$ — all the same gap! When that happens, the answer is $\text{LCM}(16,18,21) - 13$. $\text{LCM}(16,18,21) = 1008$. Answer = $1008-13 = 995$.

Q: Method — 'least number leaving the SAME remainder in every case': Find the least number which, when divided by 6, 7, 8, 9, and 12, leaves the same remainder 1 in every case.

A: When the remainder is identical across all divisors, the answer is $\text{LCM}(\text{divisors}) + \text{remainder}$. $\text{LCM}(6,7,8,9,12) = 504$. Answer = $504 + 1 = 505$.

Q: Method — 'mixed condition' (a common remainder for some divisors, but exact division for another): Find the least number which, when divided by 5, 6, 7, and 8, leaves remainder 3 in each case, but leaves NO remainder when divided by 9.

A: First find the least number leaving remainder 3 for 5,6,7,8: that's $\text{LCM}(5,6,7,8)+3 = 840+3 = 843$. But we also need it divisible by 9. Keep adding $\text{LCM}(5,6,7,8)=840$ repeatedly to 843 until the result is divisible by 9: 843 (no), 1683 ($1683 \div 9 = 187$, yes!). Answer = 1683.

Q: Method — LCM of numbers given as prime factorizations: Find the LCM of $(2 \times 3 \times 5 \times 7)$ and $(3 \times 5 \times 7 \times 11)$.

A: LCM takes the HIGHEST power of every prime that appears in either number. Primes involved: 2,3,5,7,11 — each appears at most once in either factorization, so $\text{LCM} = 2 \times 3 \times 5 \times 7 \times 11$ (just the union of all prime factors, since none repeat).

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. If the LCM of 'b' and 'b+2' is 180, and their HCF is 2, find the LCM of 'b' and 'b+1'.

A. 342 ✓

B. 380

C. 361

D. 324

Explanation: $\text{LCM} = b(b+2)/\text{HCF} = 180 \rightarrow b(b+2) = 360 \rightarrow b^2+2b-360=0 \rightarrow b=18$ (check: $18 \times 20/2 = 180$ ✓). Now $\text{LCM}(18,19)$: consecutive integers are coprime, so $\text{LCM} = 18 \times 19 = 342$. [hard, authored]

2. Find the least number which, when divided by 12, 15, and 20, leaves remainders 7, 10, and 15 respectively.

A. 55 ✓

B. 60

C. 65

D. 53

Explanation: Gaps: $12-7=5$, $15-10=5$, $20-15=5$ — all equal, so answer = $\text{LCM}(12,15,20) - 5 = 60 - 5 = 55$. [medium, authored]

3. Find the least number which, when divided by 4, 5, and 6, leaves the same remainder 2 in each case.

A. 58

B. 60

C. 62 ✓

D. 64

Explanation: $\text{LCM}(4,5,6) = 60$. Answer = $60 + 2 = 62$. [easy, authored]

4. Find the LCM of $(2 \times 2 \times 3 \times 5)$ and $(2 \times 3 \times 3 \times 7)$.

A. $2 \times 2 \times 3 \times 3 \times 5 \times 7$ ✓

B. $2 \times 3 \times 5 \times 7$

C. $2 \times 2 \times 3 \times 5 \times 7$

D. $4 \times 9 \times 5 \times 7$

Explanation: Take the highest power of each prime: 2^2 (from the first), 3^2 (from the second), 5^1 , 7^1 . $\text{LCM} = 2^2 \times 3^2 \times 5 \times 7$, which equals option (A) written out as $2 \times 2 \times 3 \times 3 \times 5 \times 7$. [medium, authored]

5. The LCM of two consecutive integers n and $n+1$ is always:

A. $n + 1$

B. $n(n+1)$ ✓

C. $n - 1$

D. Cannot be determined

Explanation: Consecutive integers are always coprime ($\text{HCF}=1$), so their LCM is simply their product, $n(n+1)$. [easy, authored]

Part C – General English: Poem: "I Dream of Spices" — Raj Arumugam

READING MATERIAL

One of 30 poems (alongside 29 prose pieces) in Part C Unit VII Literary Works — a 15-question unit covering all 59 works, so any single poem is low-probability to get more than 1 question, but the exam draws from author facts, plot details, glossary words, and figures of speech in roughly equal measure, so cover all four angles rather than just the story.

Q: Who wrote "I Dream of Spices", and what's known about him?

A: Raj Arumugam. Born in India (1955), he moved to Singapore before age 6, lived there until 1997, spent a year in the UK, and has lived in Australia since 1998. He is a teacher, poet and writer.

Q: Does this poem have an alternate/fuller title?

A: Yes — its full original title is "absent-mindedness; or I Dream of Spices", which directly names the poem's theme (the boy's absent-mindedness) before the shortened textbook title does.

Q: What kind of poem is this, structurally and tonally?

A: A short, humorous, free-verse poem (no fixed rhyme/meter pattern) written in a simple, child-friendly narrative style.

Q: How does the poem's story begin?

A: The narrator, a young boy named Raj, is sent by his mother to Muthu's shop to buy some items, and he sets off happily singing songs along the way.

Q: What were the items on the mother's original shopping list?

A: Cinnamon, betel leaves, ginger, and garlic.

Q: What happened when Muthu asked the boy what he wanted?

A: The boy had completely forgotten the original list and instead rattled off ('rattled off' = recited quickly) a brand-new list: sesame seeds, onions, tomatoes, and pickles — none of which were on his mother's actual list.

Q: What happened when the boy got home with the wrong items, and how did he react?

A: His mother twisted his ears in mild punishment, and he cried out "Ouch!" in pain.

Q: What is the central theme/message of the poem?

A: Childhood innocence and forgetfulness, told humorously — the boy is so happily lost in daydreaming (dreaming of spices, hence the title) that he forgets his actual task entirely and improvises a whole new (wrong) list. The humor comes from the totality of the mistake — he doesn't forget one item, he replaces the entire list.

Q: What do these words from the poem mean? — cinnamon, rattle off, sesame seeds

A: Cinnamon: the bark of a tree, used as a flavouring spice. Rattle off: to recite/say something quickly without much thought. Sesame seeds: also called gingelly seeds, used in cooking.

Q: What figure of speech (sound device) is most evident in the poem, with examples?

A: Alliteration — repetition of the same starting consonant sound in nearby words. Examples: "sesame seeds" (s-sound), "ginger and garlic" (g-sound), "mother... my" (m-sound in 'Mother twists my ears').

Q: Beyond alliteration, what literary device describes the poem's overall comic premise?

A: Situational irony — the boy spends the walk happily 'dreaming of spices' (the very thing he was sent to buy), yet ends up forgetting every single one of them. The gap between what we'd expect (he's thinking about spices, so he should remember them) and what actually happens (he forgets them completely) is the ironic comic core of the poem. If an exam question asks for 'the poetic device used' without further context, be ready for either alliteration (sound-level) or irony (structural/thematic level) as the intended answer — both are defensible depending on which line or aspect the question points to.

Q: Trap-style question to watch for: which of the shopping items was NOT on the original list?

A: Be careful — TNPSC-style questions mix items from both lists as distractors. The original list was cinnamon/betel leaves/ginger/garlic; the substituted (wrong) list was sesame seeds/onions/tomatoes/pickles. Any item from the second list (e.g. tomatoes) is correctly 'NOT on the original list' — but a hastily-read question could trick you into picking ginger or garlic, which WERE on the original list.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. Who is the author of the poem "I Dream of Spices"?

A. Sarojini Naidu

B. Ruskin Bond

C. Raj Arumugam ✓

D. Rabindranath Tagore

Explanation: Raj Arumugam, born in India in 1955. [easy, web-research]

2. Where was the poet Raj Arumugam born, before later living in Singapore, the UK, and Australia?

A. Malaysia

B. India ✓

C. Singapore

D. Sri Lanka

Explanation: He was born in India in 1955 and moved to Singapore before he turned six. [medium, web-research]

3. "I Dream of Spices" is mainly about:

A. A recipe for making spice powder

B. A boy forgetting his mother's shopping list ✓

C. A trader selling spices at a market

D. A festival celebrating spices

Explanation: It's a humorous narrative of a boy who forgets his shopping list entirely and buys the wrong items. [easy, web-research]

4. Who sent the boy to the shop in the poem?

A. His father

B. His grandmother

C. His mother ✓

D. His teacher

Explanation: His mother sent him to Muthu's shop. [easy, web-research]

5. What was the name of the shopkeeper in the poem?

A. Mani

B. Muthu ✓

C. Magesh

D. Murugan

Explanation: The shopkeeper's name was Muthu. [easy, web-research]

6. Which of the following was on the mother's ORIGINAL shopping list?

A. Sesame seeds

B. Tomatoes

C. Betel leaves ✓

D. Pickles

Explanation: The original list was cinnamon, betel leaves, ginger, and garlic. Sesame seeds, tomatoes, and pickles were all part of the wrong list the boy invented instead. [medium, web-research]

7. What did the boy actually ask Muthu for, having forgotten the real list?

A. Rice and dhal

B. Tea and coffee

C. Sesame seeds, onions, tomatoes and pickles ✓

D. Turmeric and salt

Explanation: He rattled off a completely new list: sesame seeds, onions, tomatoes, and pickles. [medium, web-research]

8. What did the boy do on his way to the shop, before forgetting the list?

A. He ran the whole way

B. He sang songs happily ✓

C. He stopped to play

D. He fell asleep on a bench

Explanation: He went along singing songs, happily lost in his own world — which sets up why he forgot the list. [easy, web-research]

9. How did the boy's mother react when he returned with the wrong items?

A. She laughed it off

B. She twisted his ears ✓

C. She sent him back immediately

D. She scolded Muthu instead

Explanation: She twisted his ears, and he cried "Ouch!" [easy, web-research]

10. "Rattle off" as used in the poem means:

A. To forget completely

B. To recite quickly ✓

C. To write something down carefully

D. To shake violently

Explanation: It means to say/recite something quickly, often without much thought — exactly what the boy did with his invented list. [medium, web-research]

11. Which figure of speech is illustrated by "ginger and garlic" and "sesame seeds" in the poem?

A. Simile

B. Alliteration ✓

C. Metaphor

D. Hyperbole

Explanation: Alliteration — repeated initial consonant sounds (g-sound, s-sound). [medium, web-research]

12. The poem's full/original title, beyond the shortened textbook title, is:

A. "A Boy's Mistake"

B. "absent-mindedness; or I Dream of Spices" ✓

C. "The Spice Market"

D. "Muthu's Shop"

Explanation: The poet's original published title is "absent-mindedness; or I Dream of Spices". [hard, web-research]